to participate in India's financial services growth opportunity. Our lending portfolio has grown more than threefold, from ₹55,180 crore in March 2022 to approximately ₹1.7 lakh crore in June 2026. Over this period, we have moved from being the ninth-largest to the fifth-largest diversified NBFC. This scale-up has been accompanied by a significant improvement in asset quality.

We identified housing finance as a key growth opportunity in 2022 and have since built a full-stack housing finance franchise spanning prime, affordable and construction finance. Lending will continue to be an important growth driver for us. The opportunity remains significant, and our focus will be on scaling these businesses. We also believe our asset management, life insurance, and health insurance businesses are well-positioned to capture the long-term opportunity.

**Q: Today, we are increasingly seeing women in leadership roles. Yet, at the same time, there is also a large gap that still exists. Have things become easier for women to climb the leadership ladder, or are there still things that need to be sorted?**

**A:** Things have certainly improved. Today, we see more women taking on leadership roles, managing large teams and leading businesses, in ways that were far less common a decade ago. Organisations are more conscious of the need to build diverse leadership pipelines.

I think women do think differently from men. Therefore, there is a strong business logic for diversity, and gender is an important part of that. At Aditya Birla Group, we consciously believe in diversity, not only gender but all forms of diversity. A lot of positive change has happened. Now, we need more and more women to believe in their capabilities and walk this path without giving up.

**"Lending will continue to be important... The opportunity is significant, and our focus will be on scaling our various businesses"**

**Q: How have you addressed diversity at Aditya Birla Capital?**

**A:** At Aditya Birla Capital, we believe that diversity is integral to building a stronger, more innovative and future-ready organisation. Women represented 33% of our workforce in FY26, and we continue to strengthen representation at senior levels.

We have initiatives like our diversity council. I personally interact with young women, and we have created support groups because many times you become uncertain. It happened in my own career. When I had my first child, I evaluated my options, and that was despite having a very loving and supportive husband and in-laws. At that time, fellow women colleagues and seniors came forward and assured me that this phase would pass and things would settle. I am grateful that I got that advice.

We try to replicate that at Aditya Birla Capital. We have created support groups and have a very senior HR leader heading our diversity initiatives. The biggest support often comes from someone simply assuring you that what you are going through is normal and that

